wasn't a traitor. So, please, my lord, don't assume that I'm treacherous just because I'm poor, with no titles to my name.

CELIA: Dear master, listen to me.

DUKE FREDERICK: Yes, Celia, we kept her here for your sake. Otherwise, she would have been banished with her father.

CELIA: At that time, I didn't beg you to keep her here; you wanted her here, and you felt guilty. I was too young at the time to appreciate her value, but now I know her. If she's a traitor, why then, so am I.

DUKE FREDERICK: She's too devious for you. Her smoothness, her silence, and her patient suffering appeal to the people, and they pity her. You're a fool. She's robbing you of the attention you deserve. You will seem even brighter and more virtuous when she's out of the picture. So be quiet. The sentence I've passed down on her is firm and unshakeable. She is banished.

CELIA: Then lay that sentence on me too, my lord. I cannot live without her.

DUKE FREDERICK: You are a fool.—You, niece, prepare to leave. On my honour and by my word, if you outstay the ten days, you will die.

(Exit DUKE FREDERICK and lords)

CELIA: Oh, my poor Rosalind, where will you go? Do you want to exchange fathers? I'll give you mine. I insist, don't be more distressed than I am.

ROSALIND: I have more reason to be distressed.

CELIA: No you haven't, cousin. Please, be cheerful. Don't you realize the duke has also banished me, his daughter?

ROSALIND: No, he hasn't.

CELIA: Oh, he hasn't? Well, then, you don't have the affection that would teach you that you and I are one. Will we be separated? Should we part, sweet girl? No. Let my father find another heir. So, help me plan how we'll escape, where we'll go, and what we'll take with us.

ROSALIND: But where will we go?

CELIA: To the Forest of Arden, to find your father.

ROSALIND: But what danger we'll put ourselves in, two young, innocent women travelling so far! Fresh beauty attracts thugs and thieves even more than money.

CELIA: I'll put on some poor and ragged clothes and smudge my face with dirt. You do the same, and we'll be able to travel without attracting any attackers' attention.

ROSALIND: Wouldn't it be better—since I'm unusually tall for a woman—to dress myself like a man? I'll wear a big sword in my belt, carry a boar-spear in my hand, and hide all my womanish fear in my heart. We'll maintain a swaggering, warrior look, like so many cowardly men, whose manner has nothing to do with what they're feeling.

CELIA: What should I call you when you're a man?

ROSALIND: I'll take no lesser name than that of Jove's own servant. So call me Ganymede. And what will you be called?

CELIA: Something that refers to my current state. Instead of Celia, call me Aliena.

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